

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 808

By Hatcher

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Blount County Mayor Ed Mitchell on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of public service; and

WHEREAS, Ed Mitchell is one such estimable individual, who has served the citizens of Blount County with distinction, including four consecutive terms as Blount County Mayor from 2010 until the conclusion of his current term in 2026; and

WHEREAS, a passionate sixth-generation Blount Countian, Mayor Mitchell continues to reside on his family's farm, first settled in 1800 by his great-great-great-grandfather, reflecting a deep and abiding connection to the land and the people he has long served; and

WHEREAS, Ed Mitchell is a graduate of Everett High School, Class of 1972, and Tusculum College, where he earned a Bachelor of Science degree in Organizational Management; and

WHEREAS, prior to his service as county mayor, Mayor Mitchell devoted thirty-two years to public service in Blount County, including four and one-half years with the Blount County Sheriff's Department and twenty-seven years with the Maryville Fire Department, where he served six years as fire marshal and fifteen years as fire chief; and

WHEREAS, following a brief retirement devoted to farming Black Angus cattle, Ed Mitchell was elected Blount County Mayor and was subsequently reelected in 2014, 2018, and 2022, providing steady leadership and continuity through four election cycles; and

WHEREAS, during Mayor Mitchell's tenure, Blount County has experienced a remarkable financial transformation, reducing county debt from \$238 million to an anticipated \$87 million by June 2026, increasing the fund balance from \$9 million to \$63 million, and

improving net assets from a negative \$75 million to \$154 million, all while maintaining balanced budgets each year; and

WHEREAS, under his leadership, Blount County achieved a AAA credit rating, completed multiple consecutive clean audits, maintained a tax rate below the certified rate, and incurred no new debt while making substantial investments in education, public facilities, and infrastructure; and

WHEREAS, Mayor Ed Mitchell oversaw the construction of a new high school, more than \$80 million in capital improvements to the county's other high schools, a \$21 million renovation of Eagleton Ballpark, and the execution of a lease agreement ensuring the long-term viability of Blount Memorial Hospital; and

WHEREAS, he placed a strong emphasis on modernization and efficiency in county government, launching an information technology modernization program in 2017 that included fiber infrastructure, updated accounting systems, a new county website, and improved communications systems; and

WHEREAS, Mayor Mitchell also fostered collaboration among county departments, municipalities, and community partners, contributing to major business recruitment and expansion efforts, regional fiber connectivity initiatives, and the development of a transition center in partnership with the McNabb Center; and

WHEREAS, his commitment to public safety included the establishment of an emergency medical responder certification program for the Blount County Sheriff's Office, resulting in more than eighty deputies receiving emergency medical certification and saving countless lives; and

WHEREAS, wholly dedicated to his community, Mayor Mitchell has served on numerous boards and committees, including the Blount County Community Action Board, the American Red Cross Board, Keep Blount Beautiful, the American Heart Association, the Homeland Security District 2 Board, the Boys and Girls Club of Blount County, and the Empty Pantry Board; he is a graduate of Leadership Blount, Class of 1998; and

WHEREAS, he currently serves on the Economic Development Board of Blount County and the Tellico Reservoir Development Agency, and he is a member of the Maryville Kiwanis Club; and

WHEREAS, known for his open-door policy and servant's heart, Mayor Ed Mitchell has remained accessible to the citizens of Blount County and is especially recognized for his annual volunteer service during the holiday season, as he brings joy and goodwill to community events throughout the county; and

WHEREAS, Mayor Mitchell is a fourth-generation member of Broadway United Methodist Church, reflecting a deep and enduring family connection to his faith and community; and

WHEREAS, Ed Mitchell enjoys the love and support he shares with his wife of forty-two years, Kim Mitchell; he is the proud father of two sons, Josh and Jordan, and the loving grandfather of Mason, Lily, and Ella; and

WHEREAS, a strong advocate for the citizens of Blount County, Mayor Mitchell has compiled a singular record of success during his exemplary public service career, and he should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Blount County Mayor Ed Mitchell for his exemplary service to the people of Blount County and the State of Tennessee, extending to him our sincere appreciation and best wishes upon the occasion of his retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.